

▲ Plate 2.4 Protective and Regulatory Foods

Fruits, vegetables, green leafy vegetables, milk, egg, fish and liver serve as protective and regulatory foods.

2.1.2 Social Functions of Food

- Food is a symbol of hospitality throughout the world.
- It is a part of community, social, cultural and religious life.
- It creates a relaxed atmosphere when people are together and it is an instrument for developing social rapport.

DO YOU KNOW?

How much fluid do we need?

An individual should drink 1.5 - 2 litres of fluid daily to maintain healthy kidney and prevent urinary infections.

The body needs extra fluids when energy expenditure is high and also in hot weather.

- Food is a vehicle for expressing love, friendship and social acceptance in the events like festivals, marriage and birthday party.

2.1.3 Psychological Functions of Food

- Gives mental happiness
- Provides sense of security
- Relieves stress and gives pleasure.

2.2 Four Food Groups and Food Pyramid

2.2.1 Significance of the Four Basic Food Groups

The four food groups can be used for the following purposes.

i) Planning wholesome, balanced menus to achieve nutritional adequacy

ii) Assessing nutritional status – a brief diet history of an individual can disclose inadequacies of food and nutrients from any of the four food groups. Based on the assessment, nutrition education can be given to an individual.

2.2.2 ICMR Basic Four Food Groups

According to Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) the nutrients in Basic four food groups are given in table 2.1.

2.2.3 Food Pyramid

The food guide pyramid was introduced in 1992 by United States Department of Agriculture (USDA). It is a valuable

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